

Open it anywhere. Most chapters end by giving you permission to stop.

Most quotation books hand you a beautiful sentence and walk away. You read forty in a sitting, feel briefly elevated, and by Thursday you could not name one of them.

This one is built the other way round. Every line arrives with two things: what it actually means, in plain English, and one specific place to put it. The row you are rehearsing in the car. The email you have not answered. The thing you keep not starting.

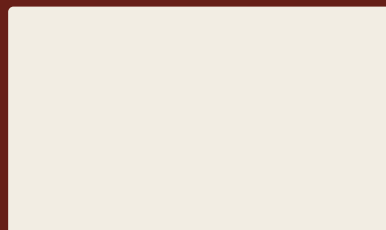
Two hundred and forty entries, arranged by the problem you have rather than the century it came from. Marcus Aurelius on obstacles, Aesop on persuasion, an English proverb on knowing when to leave a thing alone. They contradict each other in places, which is what real advice does.

“When angry, count to ten before you speak. If very angry, a hundred.”

Thomas Jefferson

HOW TO USE IT Build the delay into the tools where you do the damage. Say out loud that you will answer tomorrow. Write the furious message in a blank note instead of the reply box.

240 ENTRIES · 16 CHAPTERS · 130 SOURCES



Lines Worth Keeping

A COMMONPLACE BOOK

Lines Worth Keeping

A commonplace book of 240 quotations, each with what it means and where to put it.

240 ENTRIES · 16 CHAPTERS